

EVERYDAY MILLIONAIRE

Mitch learned his incredible work ethic from his dad while working the two-hundred-acre family farm. That's right—*another* farm-bred millionaire. They'd work side by side all day, and Mitch was amazed at how his dad managed to outwork everyone else. "It was hard work," Mitch said, "but it taught us a lot of good values, such as how to run a business, how to make money, and how to get ahead."

Mitch put those lessons to use early in life. He excelled at academics and sports in high school, and he learned that he could do anything that he set his mind to and was willing to work for. After graduating at the top of his class, he started college and developed a passion for flying. He earned his pilot's license with the intention of flying commercially, but he had a hard time finding a pilot position out of school. He took a job as an air traffic controller instead, staying there for eleven years—until a massive industry strike cost him his job and forced him to find a new line of work. After weighing his options, Mitch decided to return to the family farm, which has since grown to eight hundred acres. He also began investing in real estate, building up a portfolio of thirty-five properties. Never wanting to worry about losing his job again, Mitch focused on building multiple income streams. He told us one of the keys to his long-term success has been working in two or three different businesses over many years.

Mitch taught himself the basics of investing in his late thirties to make the best use of his income. He invested in a 401(k) and an IRA in addition to his real estate investments. His wife, Leah, has also worked throughout their entire marriage. She started investing into her company's retirement plan at age twenty-five—jumping into the 401(k) when that rolled out—and worked there for forty years. She made the 401(k) a priority that entire time, and she and Mitch never even considered borrowing against it or withdrawing it early—even during Mitch's career change. Today, Leah has \$1 million in her 401(k). The couple would be millionaires on her 401(k) alone, but that's just one piece of this incredible couple's wealth. When you add that to Mitch's accounts, the eight-hundred-acre farm, and thirty-five properties, they have a total net worth of \$9 million. These two have absolutely killed it through their intense focus and hard work.

Mitch's dad always told him, "Isn't it funny how the people who work the hardest are the 'luckiest' people?" That incredible work ethic has fueled Mitch and Leah's success for decades, and now they are living the "luckiest" life of their dreams. The couple still works hard, but they do it on their terms and only as much (or little) as they want to. They play hard, too, taking at least five separate two-week vacations a year, and often moving into their Florida vacation home for weeks at a time. That's the kind of life you can live if you're not scared to work hard to reach your goals.
